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Thousand Pillar Temple

The **Thousand Pillar Temple** or **Rudreswara Swamy Temple**[1] is a historical Hindu temple located in the city of Hanamakonda, Telangana, India.[2] It is dedicated to Shiva, Vishnu and Surya. The Thousand Pillar Temple, along with the Warangal Fort and the Kakatiya Kala Thoranam were added to the tentative list of UNESCO World Heritage sites.[3]

Thousand Pillar Temple	
వెయ్యి స్తంభాల గుడి	
Thousand Pillar temple	
Religion	
Affiliation	Hinduism
Deity	Shiva, Vishnu, Surya
Governing body	P.Venugopal, Gr-II (Endowments department of Telangana)
Location	
Location	Hanamakonda, India
State	Telangana
Country	India
Location in Telangana State	

History

Many Hindu temples were developed under the patronage of Kakatiya rulers Ganapati Deva, Rudrama Devi and Prataparudra. The Thousand Pillar Temple was believed to have been constructed between 1175 and 1324 CE by the order of the Kakatiya king Rudra Deva. Dedicated primarily to Shiva, the temple is also known by the name of Sri Rudreshwara Swamy Temple.

It was desecrated by the Tughlaq dynasty during their invasion of the Deccan.

However, the 7th Nizam of Hyderabad, Mir Osman Ali Khan, donated a grant of 1 Lakh INR towards the reconstruction of this temple.[4][5][6]

The executive officer of the temple is P. Venugopal Gr-II. He has brought many changes to the administration and development of the temple.[7]

At this temple, three Hindu deities Shiva, Vishnu, and Surya are worshipped. They are known collectively as the *Trikutalayam*.

Architecture

The Thousand Pillar Temple with its ruins lies near the Hanamkonda-Warangal Highway in Telangana, about 150 kilometres (93 mi) from the city of Hyderabad.

Sculpture of Nandi at Thousand Pillar Temple

Thousand Pillar Temple (India)

Coordinates	18°00′13.4″N 79°34′29.1″E
Architecture	
Type	Kakatiya, Chalukya, Kadamba architecture/Vesara
Creator	Rudra Deva
Completed	1163 CE

Rudreswara Temple locally known in Telugu as the *Veyyi Stambhāla Guḍi* (Telugu: వెయ్యి స్తంభాల గుడి; lit. "thousand pillar temple"). It is one of the earliest available examples of Kakatiya art, architecture and sculpture. It was built in the style of later Chalukyan and early Kakatiyan Architecture, star-shaped and triple shrined (Trikutalaya). The temple has one thousand pillars. There are richly carved pillars, perforated screens, exquisite icons, rock cut elephants and the monolithic dolerite Nandi as components of the temple. Strengthening of foundations like sandbox technique, the skill of Kakatiya sculptors is manifest in adroit craftsmanship and flawless ivory carving technique in their art. The ingenuity of Kakatiya sculptors is visible in likes of lathe turned, and shiny polish in dolerite and granite stone sculpture and craftwork of Nava Rangamandapa.

The temple was renovated in 2004 by the Government of India. Archaeological Survey of India and modern engineers have been working for the temple's further renovation.

Transport

The nearest railway station is Warangal railway station, which is 6 kilometres (3.7 miles) away from the temple. Rajiv Gandhi International Airport is the nearest airport to this temple.

References

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7. "Thousand Pillar temple" (http://www.templedetails.com/thousand-pillar-temple-warangal/). September 2016.

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- Picture of 1000 Pillar Temple (https://www.flickr.com/photos/vijaynandula/7202142696/in/photostream/)

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